

Practice Sheet • Answers

For the coach. Accept a good reason in the student's own words.

Q	Answer	Why
1	4.Ng5	The knight and the bishop both attack f7. Only the king defends it.
2	6.Nxf7!	The knight attacks the queen and the rook. After 6...Kxf7, 7.Qf3+ attacks the king and the knight on d5.
3	8.Qxd5+ Qxd5 9.Bxd5+ Be6 10.Bxe6#	The black king is trapped on the a2–g8 diagonal. (8.Bxd5+ first also works.)
4	8.Bxd5	Threat: Qf7#, checkmate.
5	8.Nc3	Now three white pieces attack d5: the queen, the bishop and the knight.
6	5...Na5!	The knight attacks the bishop on c4. When the bishop moves away, f7 is safe.
7	6...c6 or 6...Bd7	Both block the bishop's check. 6...c6 is the main move.
8	4.d4!	It opens the centre while Black's pieces are still at home.
9	11.Bxh6! (mate on g7)	Now the queen on g4 and the bishop on h6 both attack g7. Qxg7# is coming.
10	4...Nxe4! 5.Nxe4 d5!	The d5 pawn attacks the bishop and the knight at the same time. Black wins the piece back.
11	4.b4	If Black takes it, White plays c3 and d4 and gets a big centre.
12	8.Bxf7+ Kxf7 9.Qd5+ Kf8 10.Qxc5+	9.Qd5+ is a check that also attacks the bishop. Black's king can never castle.
13	10.Qh5!	Threat 1: Qxh7# (checkmate). Threat 2: Nxf7, winning the rook. Black can't stop both.
14	14.Nf6+! gxf6 15.Bxf6	The black king loses its pawn cover. White's queen comes to g5 or h5 next.
15	12.Qb5+	After Black blocks, 13.Qxa5 wins the bishop.